

KELETSO MAKOFANE, MPH, PHD (he/him/his)

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PROFILE

Award-winning, results-driven social network epidemiologist with 10+ years leading mission-focused research in biosecurity and infectious diseases. Proficient in advanced data analytics and threat-model development using R and Neo4j. Collaborative across disciplines—from AI practitioners and web developers to qualitative researchers. Globally recognized expert in policy, advocacy, governance, infectious diseases, and human rights.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Leadership, flexibility, communication, teamwork, problem-solving, adaptability, motivation, integrity, results-driven

EXPERIENCE

- CTRL+F, Co-Founder** 2023 — Present
- Started a consulting group that services mission-driven clients in public health and medicine
 - Oversee business operations, including project management, accounting, and client relationships
 - Create high-impact strategies and content for clients, such as Grindr and Frontline AIDS
- UNIVERSITY OF PENNSYLVANIA, Postdoctoral Fellow, Center for Causal Inference** 2023 — 2025
- Serve as Principal Investigator of RESPND-MI, a community-led response to mpox
 - Raised \$150,000 to fund research activities, coordinating a team of 15 co-investigators
 - Implemented the MPX NYC campaign and survey to inform distribution of limited vaccine supply
- HAALSA HEALTH AND AGING STUDIES IN AFRICA, Co-Investigator and Member, Biostats Core** 2022 — 2025
- Trained staff on operations for HAALSA, a set of longitudinal observational studies in South Africa
 - Contributed scientific writing to \$5.5 million (per annum) NIH grant supporting HAALSA
 - Developed methods for measuring and analyzing network-embedded wealth and health outcomes
- HARVARD UNIVERSITY, Health and Human Rights Fellow, FXB Center for Health & Human Rights** 2021 — 2023
- Led The Constellations Project, an initiative to visualize network of scholars researching racism
 - Designed and coded The Constellations Project collaborations map and facilitated a launch event
- GEORGETOWN UNIVERSITY, Scholar, O'Neill Institute for National and Global Health Law** 2020 — 2021
- Developed data analysis for a report of the Community-Led Monitoring of Health Services initiative, which assists community members with data-driven advocacy for health care services
- MPACT GLOBAL ACTION, Senior Program Associate and Researcher** 2012 — 2017
- Joined World Health Organization and UNAIDS scientific and consultative working groups
 - Steered data design and analysis for two waves of the Global Men Health and Right Survey, whose findings shaped World Health Organization's guidance on HIV for sexual minority men
- ANOVA HEALTH INSTITUTE, MSM Technical Advisor** 2014 — 2017
- Managed a 45-person team for outreach services and HIV testing across eight South African cities

EDUCATION

- HARVARD UNIVERSITY** 2017 — 2020
Doctor of Philosophy in Social Network Epidemiology
- COLUMBIA UNIVERSITY** 2010 — 2012
Master of Public Health in Biostatistics, Fulbright Scholarship
- UNIVERSITY OF CAPE TOWN** 2006 — 2009
Bachelor of Business Science in Actuarial Science

DATA SKILLS, TOOLS, AND LANGUAGES

Epidemiology, Causal inference, Data analysis, Network science, Data wrangling, Data modeling, Statistics, Data visualization, Programming, Quantitative analysis, Regression analysis, JavaScript, React, R, AWS, Neo4j

SELECT HONORS

Reviewer of the Year (*American Journal of Epidemiology*), LGBTQ Advocates Changing the World (*Out Magazine*)

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BOARDS AND COMMITTEES

THE LANCET , Member, <i>IAS-Lancet Commission on the Future of HIV Response and Global Health</i>	2016 — Present
WORLD HEALTH ORGANIZATION	
<i>Strategic and Technical Advisory Committee on HIV and Viral Hepatitis, Member</i>	2017 — 2025
<i>Civil Society Reference Group on HIV, Member</i>	2014 — 2017
<i>Consolidated Guidelines on HIV for Key Populations, Member</i>	2014
PERCEPT , Member, Board of Directors	2023
LVCT HEALTH , Member, Board of Directors	2019 — 2024
GLOBAL BLACK GAY MEN CONNECT , Member, Board of Directors	2020 — 2023
INTERNATIONAL AIDS SOCIETY , Member, Governing Council	2018 — 2022
UNAIDS , Member, <i>Global Platform to Fast-Track HIV Responses</i>	2016 — 2017

MEMBERSHIP IN PROFESSIONAL ORGANIZATIONS

Public Health Association of South Africa, International AIDS Society, Society for Epidemiological Research

SERVICE TO PROFESSION

Peer Reviewer: *Journal of the International AIDS Society, PLOS One, African Journal of AIDS Research, African Journal of AIDS Research, BMC Medicine, The BMJ, American Journal of Epidemiology, Health Equity, Critical Public Health*

SAMPLE OF PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

Makofane, K., Kim, H.Y., Tchetgen Tchetgen, E., Bassett, M.T., Berkman, L., Adeagbo, O., McGrath, N., Seeley, J., Shahmanesh, M., Yapa, H.M., Herbst, K., Tanser, F., & Bärnighausen, T. (2023). Impact of Family Networks on Uptake of Health Interventions: Evidence from a community-randomized control trial aimed at increasing HIV Testing in South Africa. *Journal of the International AIDS Society*, 26(8), e26142.

Roth, G., Barnes-Balenciaga, J., Osmundson, J., Smith, M.D.R., Tran, N.K., Diamond, N., Makofane, K. (2023) Global North learning from Global South: A community-led response to mpox in New York City. *PLOS Glob Public Health* 3(6): e0002042. <https://doi.org/10.1371/journal.pgph.0002042>

Thornhill, J. P., Barkati, S., Walmsley, S., Rockstroh, J., Antinori, A., Harrison, L. B., Palich, R., Nori, A., Reeves, I., Habibi, M.S., Apea, V., Boesecke, C., Vandekerckhove, L., Yakubovsky, M., Sendagorta, E., Blanco, J.L., Florence, E., Moschese, D., Maltez, F.M., Goorhuis, A., Pourcher, V., Migaud, P., Noe, S., Pintando, C., Maggi, F., Hansen, A.E., Hoffmann, C., Lezama, J.I., Mussini, C., Cattelan, A., Makofane, K., Tan, D., Nozza, S., Nemeth, K., Klein, M.B., & Orkin, C. M. (2022). Monkeypox virus infection in humans across 16 countries—April–June 2022. *New England Journal of Medicine*, 387(8). doi: 10.1056/NEJMoa2207323

SAMPLE OF MEDIA MENTIONS

Advocates use end of Pride Month to warn about mpox — CBS News, 2024 (television appearance)

Thank You, WHO and Africa CDC, for Declaring Mpox a Public Health Emergency — POZ Magazine, 2024

Epidemiologist On How to Stop Spread of Monkeypox — MSNBC, 2022 (television appearance)

Monkeypox Outbreak Growing Around the World — MSNBC, 2022 (television appearance)

With support on monkeypox hard to come by, queer communities turn to one another — STAT News, 2022

How to Fight Monkeypox: LGBTQ Activists on Stigma and Centering Community — Teen VOGUE, 2022

U.S. Monkeypox Response Has Been Woefully Inadequate, Experts Say — Scientific American, 2022

Why the monkeypox outbreak is mostly affecting men who have sex with men — Science, 2022

Monkeypox is rousing old fears — and ways gay men care for each other — The Washington Post, 2022

The Best Way to Slow the Spread of Monkeypox — Time, 2022

Ring Vaccination Beat Smallpox. Could It Work for Monkeypox? — Wired, 2022

An open letter to the Biden administration on monkeypox — Harvard Public Health Magazine, 2022

Homophobic misinformation is making it harder to contain the spread of monkeypox — MIT Technology Review, 2022

Monkeypox outbreak in U.S. is bigger than the CDC reports. Testing is 'abysmal' — National Public Radio, 2022

Monkeypox is Not a Gay Disease — PLOS, 2022

To fight monkeypox, remember the lessons of COVID and HIV — The New York Times Opinion, 2022